

Cybersecurity Career Roadmap

A step-by-step guide from zero experience to your first cybersecurity role.

Stage 1: Foundations (Months 1-2)

- Learn basic networking: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, ports
- Get comfortable with Linux and the command line
- Understand the CIA Triad and core security concepts
- Explore the different career paths: Blue Team, Red Team, GRC

Stage 2: Core Skills (Months 3-5)

- Learn Python basics for scripting and automation
- Practice with Kali Linux and common security tools
- Study the OWASP Top 10 web vulnerabilities
- Start solving beginner challenges on TryHackMe or HackTheBox

Stage 3: Hands-On Practice (Months 6-8)

- Set up a home lab (VirtualBox + vulnerable VMs)
- Practice reconnaissance: OSINT, Nmap, WHOIS, Google Dorking
- Try beginner bug bounty programs on HackerOne/Bugcrowd
- Document everything — start building a portfolio

Stage 4: Specialize & Get Certified (Months 9-12)

- Choose a track: penetration testing, SOC analysis, or cloud security
- Pursue an entry certification (Security+, eJPT, or similar)
- Contribute to open-source security projects
- Apply for internships, junior SOC analyst, or IT security roles

Common First Job Titles

- SOC Analyst (Tier 1)
- Junior Penetration Tester
- IT Security Support
- Security Operations Intern